

Alpian Business Technology Lead

When	Wednesday 2026-06-17, 13:30, Teams
Panel	Luca Magnoni, Damien Chambon, Sergii Kuku
Goal	Prove you can bridge regulated banking workflows, AI, data, cloud and engineering delivery.
Status	Legitimacy: High Confidence. Report: 119.

I turn regulated banking pain points into production-safe automation: discover the workflow, translate it into implementable specs, align business and engineering, preserve auditability, and measure impact.

Do not frame it as

"Ex-CTO looking for a smaller role."

Frame it as

"I want a high-leverage role close to real banking operations, where AI improves measurable workflows rather than becoming slide-deck transformation."

Opening Narrative

My background is at the intersection of regulated financial technology, product and engineering delivery, and practical AI adoption.

At FlowBank, I led the technology organization of a FINMA-regulated neobank: roadmap, budget, target architecture, AWS transition, CRM/core banking initiatives, and a real-time data platform connecting trading, compliance, finance, marketing and quant teams.

At SCRYPT, I implemented Claude Enterprise through Slack with Linear, email and calendar integrations to make cross-functional work more structured and actionable. Before that, at UBP, I worked on audit, IAM, GDPR and control remediation. At Ripple/Metaco, I led engineering for a regulated institutional custody platform.

What attracts me to Alpian is that the role starts from real banking operations: Compliance, KYC, transaction monitoring, operational controls, and production delivery. That is the right place for AI and automation in a bank.

Company Signals

- FINMA-licensed Swiss digital bank, majority-owned by Fideuram - Intesa Sanpaolo Private Banking.
- 2025 results: client base +65%, invested assets +127%, gross banking commissions more than tripled, net loss fell year on year.
- Radicant portfolio migration completed in April 2026.
- Surpassed 40,000 clients and CHF 289M in client assets including Pillar 3a.
- 2026 priorities include AI for operational efficiency and client services.

Alpian is now in a scaling phase, not only a launch phase. Client growth, Radicant migration, product expansion and explicit AI priorities make operational technology a real business lever.

Panel Lenses

Luca Magnoni - CTO

Lens: technology strategy, architecture, production risk, role fit.

Prove: you can bridge business and engineering without architecture theatre.

Damien Chambon - Cloud & AI/Data Director

Lens: cloud/data/AI, automation patterns, compliance-safe AI.

Prove: you understand data flows, governance, human-in-the-loop design and production adoption.

Sergii Kuku - Engineering Director

Lens: delivery, engineering collaboration, specs, operational ownership.

Prove: you will make engineering more effective, not dump vague business requirements on teams.

Core Positioning

Regulated fintech

Production AI

Auditability

Business + engineering

Workflow ownership

In regulated banking, the architecture is not only APIs and models. It is also responsibility, evidence and reversibility.

Your Four Stories

1. FlowBank - regulated digital bank transformation

Use for: technology strategy, banking context, cloud/data architecture, executive stakeholders.

Action: led a roughly 40-person technology department, built roadmap/budget/execution indicators, initiated AWS transition, built target architecture and data platform.

Angle: "I know the tension between banking regulation, business urgency, legacy/process constraints and delivery capacity."

2. SCRYPT - AI operating system

Use for: AI adoption, automation, change management, soft skills.

Action: Claude Enterprise through Slack with Linear, email and calendar integrations; introduced Linear company-wide; reorganized delivery/L3 ownership.

Angle: "AI adoption works when embedded into the workflow and linked to ownership."

Your Four Stories

3. UBP - control and audit mindset

Use for: compliance, KYC/controls, risk, auditability, governance.

Action: planned audits, used data analysis, wrote French/English reports, discussed remediation with departments and leadership.

Angle: "Controls are design requirements and evidence requirements."

4. Ripple/Metaco - engineering operating model

Use for: engineering collaboration, production quality, technical leadership, L3/support.

Action: led up to 50 people, organized squads, created L3 support squad, drove architecture, monitoring, QA, releases and technical debt control.

Angle: "I know how to work with engineers in a high-trust financial platform without compromising roadmap delivery."

Likely Questions

How would you identify AI opportunities in Compliance?

1. Start with workflow discovery, not model selection.
2. Map volumes, manual decisions, rework, SLA pain, audit evidence and exceptions.
3. Separate low-risk summarization, medium-risk triage, and high-risk recommendations.
4. Design for prompt/version history, input/output capture, human decision log, policy references, access controls and rollback.
5. Measure time to prepare case, time to decision, false positives, evidence quality, adoption and rework.

I would not start with "where can we put an LLM?" I would start with where analysts lose time, where evidence is hard to assemble, and where decisions need better traceability.

Likely Questions

Design an AI-assisted KYC or transaction monitoring workflow.

- **Inputs:** profile, documents, transaction history, rules, policies, sanctions/PEP/adverse media, prior notes.
- **Processing:** deterministic rules stay deterministic; AI summarizes, classifies, detects missing evidence, retrieves policy and drafts rationale.
- **Human loop:** analyst approves, rejects or edits. No autonomous adverse decision.
- **Controls:** RBAC, data minimization, model/prompt versioning, audit logs, traceable citations, reviewer sign-off.
- **Rollout:** shadow mode, limited scope, quality sampling, rollback.

The AI prepares and structures the evidence; accountable humans make regulated decisions.

Likely Questions

How do you translate business requirements into implementable specs?

- Start from the operational outcome and constraints.
- Write acceptance criteria in business and technical terms.
- Identify data sources, system boundaries, failure modes, ownership, security controls and release path.
- Validate with engineering before committing dates.
- Create metrics before building.

A good specification is a shared decision record: problem, non-goals, data, controls, success criteria and production ownership.

How do you work with engineers when you are not the line manager?

- Bring clarity, not authority theatre.
- Involve engineers early in problem framing.
- Separate discovery from delivery commitment.
- Let engineers challenge feasibility and risk.
- Make trade-offs explicit for business stakeholders.
- Protect engineering from vague urgency while keeping accountability.

My job is to reduce ambiguity before it hits engineering, and then keep enough context flowing so engineers can make good technical trade-offs.

Likely Questions

Where have you transformed a business with AI or automation?

Use SCRYPT: fragmented execution across Slack/email/meetings became Claude Enterprise integrated with Slack, Linear, email and calendars, plus company-wide Linear and clearer delivery/L3 ownership.

Bridge: apply the same pattern to Compliance/KYC/transaction monitoring by improving evidence preparation, triage and workflow visibility.

How do you make sure AI is safe in a regulated bank?

- Classify use cases by decision risk.
- Keep high-impact decisions human-owned.
- Make data access explicit and minimal.
- Keep complete audit trail.
- Test on historical cases before production.
- Monitor drift, hallucination, rework and user overrides.
- Involve Compliance, Risk, Legal and Security early.

The model is only one component. The system also includes data quality, access, human approval, audit evidence, monitoring and ownership.

Role Fit and 90 Days

This role is less senior. Why do you want it?

I have held broader leadership roles, but what matters to me here is leverage and fit. This role is close to real operational workflows in a licensed digital bank, with AI, data, cloud and production delivery all connected. I am not optimizing for title alone; I am optimizing for the quality of the mandate, the people, and the ability to turn technology into measurable banking outcomes.

First 30 days

- Understand Compliance/KYC/transaction monitoring workflows.
- Map stakeholders, systems, data flows, pain points and current metrics.
- Build trust with engineering, product, compliance, risk and operations.
- Identify 5-10 candidate automation opportunities.

First 60 / 90 Days

First 60 days

- Prioritize 2-3 use cases by value, risk and feasibility.
- Write solution specs with controls, ownership, metrics and release path.
- Define AI/data governance pattern for pilots.
- Deliver one narrow proof or shadow-mode workflow.

First 90 days

- Move one pilot toward production or controlled rollout.
- Establish dashboard for operational impact.
- Create repeatable intake/prioritization model.
- Document what should scale and what should stop.

The theme: understand the workflow first, choose narrow pilots, prove operational impact, and only then scale the pattern.

Questions To Ask

To Luca Magnoni, CTO

- Where should this role sit between business ownership, product ownership and engineering delivery?
- What are the top two technology bottlenecks preventing Alpian from scaling operationally?
- After six months, what would make you say this hire changed the way we deliver technology to the business?

To Damien Chambon, Cloud & AI/Data Director

- What is Alpian's current AI posture: internal productivity, compliance operations, client services, advisory, or all of the above?
- Which data domains are mature enough today to support automation, and where is data quality still the blocker?
- How do you balance experimentation with model/data governance in production banking workflows?

Questions To Ask

To Sergii Kuku, Engineering Director

- What type of specs help engineering teams move faster, and what type creates friction?
- Where do business requests usually lose clarity before reaching engineering?
- What is the production ownership model for business technology changes?

General close

- What is the most important operational workflow you would want me to improve first?
- What risks would you want me to avoid in the first 90 days?
- What does success look like for this role by the end of 2026?

Volunteer / Avoid

Volunteer

- You are already an Alpiant client and understand the product from the user side.
- You know Alpiant indirectly from the Swiss digital-banking ecosystem and FlowBank context.
- You have operated in FINMA-regulated environments.
- Your AI approach is pragmatic: workflow, adoption, controls, metrics.
- You can speak both to engineers and business stakeholders.

Volunteer / Avoid

Avoid

- Do not imply Alpien is a downgrade.
- Do not lead with compensation or 80-90% workload.
- Do not overclaim deep KYC/AML operations ownership.
- Do not say "AI can automate Compliance" broadly.
- Do not criticize FlowBank. Frame lessons professionally.

For KYC/AML depth: "I would not present myself as a career AML specialist. My strength is regulated banking technology, audit/control thinking, data architecture and delivery. I know how to work with Compliance experts and turn their constraints into reliable systems."

Technical Prep

- ☐ Draw an AI-assisted KYC/transaction-monitoring case workflow.
- ☐ Prepare one control design: audit logs, RBAC, human approval, model/prompt versioning, rollback.
- ☐ Review FlowBank data platform story and how it connected compliance, trading, finance, marketing and quant.
- ☐ Review UBP IAM audit story and the 0.5% user impact bug.
- ☐ Prepare SCRYPT AI operating-system story in 2-minute and 5-minute versions.
- ☐ Prepare cloud transferability: strongest proof is AWS/EKS/Terraform, not GCP, but principles transfer.
- ☐ Prepare engineering collaboration without direct line authority.
- ☐ Prepare role-fit answer for "why this role after CTO/Head of Engineering?"

Final Rehearsal

1. Rehearse the 90-second opening twice.
2. Rehearse FlowBank, SCRYPT and UBP stories in STAR format.
3. Draw the KYC/transaction-monitoring AI workflow once on paper.
4. Pick three questions if time is short.

Best three questions if time is short

- What is the first operational workflow you want this role to improve?
- Where is the main bottleneck today: data quality, tooling, process ownership or engineering capacity?
- What does success look like by end of 2026?

Short Scripts

Motivation

Alpian is compelling because it is a real licensed bank, a digital product, and now a scaling business. The role is close to the operational workflows where AI can actually create value: compliance, KYC, transaction monitoring, controls and service efficiency.

AI philosophy

I start from the workflow and the control environment. The model is only one component. In banking, the full system includes data quality, access, human approval, audit evidence, monitoring and ownership.

Working style

I am direct, structured and pragmatic. I like to make ambiguity explicit, turn it into decisions, and keep business and engineering aligned through small but concrete delivery steps.

Short Scripts

GCP gap

My direct large transformation experience is more AWS, EKS, Terraform and regulated fintech platforms. I am cloud-principles driven rather than vendor-dogmatic: identity, network boundaries, data governance, observability, deployment discipline and cost/control models transfer well.

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